LOK ADALATS AND OTHER COURTS

ARTICLE 39A AND THE → LEGAL-SERVICES AUTHORITY LADDER → SECTION 12 ELIGIBILITY AND → ORDINARY LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION → ORDINARY AWARD, FAILURE AND → PERMANENT LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

ARTICLE 39A AND THE ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE CHAIN

ARTICLE 39A AND THE ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE CHAIN · ART 39A · EQUAL-OPPORTUNITY JUSTICE + FREE LEGAL AID. · HUSSAINARA KHATOON (1979) · ART 21 FAIR PROCEDURE, LEGAL ASSISTANCE AND SPEEDY JUSTICE. · 1987 ACT · INSTITUTIONS + ELIGIBILITY + LOK ADALATS. · DIRECTIVE PRINCIPLE BECOMES OPERATIONAL THROUGH LAW AND REMEDIES.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ART 39A — equal-opportunity justice + free legal aid.
- Hussainara Khatoon (1979) — Art 21 fair procedure, legal assistance and speedy justice.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 1987 ACT — institutions + eligibility + Lok Adalats.
- VERDICT: Directive Principle becomes operational through law and remedies.

CHECK / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: Keep ordinary Lok Adalat compromise, Permanent Lok Adalat
- hybrid power, mediation, arbitration, Gram Nyayalaya and ordinary adjudication distinct.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ART 39A — equal-opportunity justice + free legal aid.
- Hussainara Khatoon (1979) — Art 21 fair procedure, legal assistance and speedy justice.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: Directive Principle becomes operational through law and remedies.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Directive Principle becomes operational through law and remedies.

01

STAGE 01

LEGAL-SERVICES AUTHORITY LADDER

LEGAL-SERVICES AUTHORITY LADDER · NATIONAL POLICY AND SCHEMES. · SUPREME COURT COMMITTEE · SUPREME COURT MATTERS. · SLSA + HIGH COURT COMMITTEE · STATE/HIGH COURT DELIVERY. · DLSA + TLSC · DISTRICT/TALUK IMPLEMENTATION.

NALSA → national policy and schemes.

SUPREME COURT COMMITTEE → Supreme Court matters. → SLSA + HIGH COURT COMMITTEE → State/High Court delivery. → DLSA + TLSC → district/taluk implementation.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- NALSA → national policy and schemes.
- SUPREME COURT COMMITTEE → Supreme Court matters.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SLSA + HIGH COURT COMMITTEE → State/High Court delivery.
- DLSA + TLSC → district/taluk implementation.

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP: statutory SLSA; not SALSA; bodies are not constitutional courts.
- NALSA → national policy and schemes.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SUPREME COURT COMMITTEE → Supreme Court matters.
- SLSA + HIGH COURT COMMITTEE → State/High Court delivery.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: statutory SLSA, not SALSA; bodies are not constitutional courts.

02

STAGE 02

SECTION 12 ELIGIBILITY AND QUALITY GATE

SECTION 12 ELIGIBILITY AND QUALITY GATE · STATUS ROUTES · SC/ST, WOMEN/CHILDREN, DISABILITY, CUSTODY, WORKMEN AND LISTED VULNERABILITY. · INCOME ROUTE · PRESCRIBED CEILING. · SECTION 13 · PRIMA FACIE CASE. · QUALITY TEST

STATUS ROUTES → SC/ST, women/children, disability, custody, workmen and listed vulnerability.

INCOME ROUTE → prescribed ceiling. → SECTION 13 → prima facie case. → QUALITY TEST: early advice + competent representation + accessible delivery.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- STATUS ROUTES → SC/ST, women/children, disability, custody, workmen and listed vulnerability.
- INCOME ROUTE → prescribed ceiling.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SECTION 13 → prima facie case.
- QUALITY TEST: early advice + competent representation + accessible delivery.

CHECK / LIMIT
- STATUS ROUTES → SC/ST, women/children, disability, custody, workmen and listed vulnerability.
- INCOME ROUTE → prescribed ceiling.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- SECTION 13 → prima facie case.
- QUALITY TEST: early advice + competent representation + accessible delivery.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALITY TEST: early advice + competent representation + accessible delivery.

03

STAGE 03

ORDINARY LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION

ORDINARY LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION · PENDING CASE OR PRE-LITIGATION DISPUTE WITHIN COURT JURISDICTION. · NON-COMPOUNDABLE OFFENCE. · STATE OF PUNJAB V. JALOUR SINGH (2008) · NO MERITS ADJUDICATION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PENDING CASE or PRE-LITIGATION DISPUTE within court jurisdiction.
- EXCLUDED → non-compoundable offence.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- PROCESS → referral/application → conciliation → compromise.
- State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008): no merits adjudication.

CHECK / LIMIT
- PENDING CASE or PRE-LITIGATION DISPUTE within court jurisdiction.
- EXCLUDED → non-compoundable offence.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- PROCESS → referral/application → conciliation → compromise.
- State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008): no merits adjudication.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: State of Punjab v. Jalour Singh (2008): no merits adjudication.

04

STAGE 04

ORDINARY AWARD, FAILURE AND REVIEW

ORDINARY AWARD, FAILURE AND REVIEW · AWARD DEEMED CIVIL-COURT DECREE · NO STATUTORY APPEAL. · NO SETTLEMENT. · PENDING CASE RETURNS · ORDINARY REMEDY CONTINUES. · WRIT CONTROL · FRAUD, NO GENUINE CONSENT, JURISDICTION OR NATURAL-JUSTICE DEFECT.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- SETTLEMENT → award deemed civil-court decree → final/binding → no statutory appeal.
- NO SETTLEMENT → pending case returns / ordinary remedy continues.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- WRIT CONTROL → fraud, no genuine consent, jurisdiction or natural-justice defect.
- FINALITY != power to compel compromise.

CHECK / LIMIT
- SETTLEMENT → award deemed civil-court decree → final/binding → no statutory appeal.
- NO SETTLEMENT → pending case returns / ordinary remedy continues.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- WRIT CONTROL → fraud, no genuine consent, jurisdiction or natural-justice defect.
- FINALITY != power to compel compromise.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WRIT CONTROL → fraud, no genuine consent, jurisdiction or natural-justice defect.

05

STAGE 05

PERMANENT LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION

PERMANENT LOK ADALAT JURISDICTION · CHAPTER VI-A · STANDING BODY FOR PUBLIC UTILITY SERVICES. · PRE-LITIGATION ONLY. · NON-COMPOUNDABLE OFFENCE + NOTIFIED PECUNIARY BOUNDARY. · INTERGLOBE AVIATION V. N. SATCHIDANAND (2011) · ORDINARY AND PERMANENT LOK ADALATS DIFFER. · CLOSE DISTINCTION

CHAPTER VI-A → standing body for PUBLIC UTILITY SERVICES. → STAGE → pre-litigation only. → BAR → non-compoundable offence + notified pecuniary boundary. → InterGlobe Aviation v. N. Satchidanand (2011): ordinary and Permanent Lok Adalats differ. → CLOSE DISTINCTION: Test each forum by statute, stage, subject matter, consent

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CHAPTER VI-A → standing body for PUBLIC UTILITY SERVICES.
- STAGE → pre-litigation only.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- BAR → non-compoundable offence + notified pecuniary boundary.
- InterGlobe Aviation v. N. Satchidanand (2011): ordinary and Permanent Lok Adalats differ.

CHECK / LIMIT
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Test each forum by statute, stage, subject matter, consent.
- merits power, award effect, appeal or review and natural-justice safeguards.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- CHAPTER VI-A → standing body for PUBLIC UTILITY SERVICES.
- STAGE → pre-litigation only.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Test each forum by statute, stage, subject matter, consent, merits power, award effect, appeal or review and natural-justice safeguards.

06

STAGE 06

PLA CONCILIATION-TO-ADJUDICATION SEQUENCE

PLA CONCILIATION-TO-ADJUDICATION SEQUENCE · CONCILIATION PAPERS · SETTLEMENT TERMS · AGREEMENT AWARD. · IF FAILURE · ELIGIBLE MERITS DECISION. · BAR COUNCIL OF INDIA V. UNION OF INDIA (2012) · DESIGN UPHELD.

APPLICATION → conciliation papers → settlement terms → agreement award. → IF FAILURE → eligible merits decision. → Bar Council of India v. Union of India (2012) → design upheld. → Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) → follow statutory conciliation sequence.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- APPLICATION → conciliation papers → settlement terms → agreement award.
- IF FAILURE → eligible merits decision.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Bar Council of India v. Union of India (2012) → design upheld.
- Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) → follow statutory conciliation sequence.

CHECK / LIMIT
- APPLICATION → conciliation papers → settlement terms → agreement award.
- IF FAILURE → eligible merits decision.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Bar Council of India v. Union of India (2012) → design upheld.
- Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) → follow statutory conciliation sequence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Canara Bank v. G.S. Jayarama (2022) → follow statutory conciliation sequence.

07

STAGE 07

GRAM NYAYALAYA AS A STATUTORY COURT

GRAM NYAYALAYA AS A STATUTORY COURT · 2008 ACT · STATE ESTABLISHMENT AFTER HIGH COURT CONSULTATION. · JMFC QUALIFICATION. · MOBILE FIRST INSTANCE · SCHEDULED CIVIL/CRIMINAL CASES + CONCILIATION · DISTRICT COURT · SESSIONS COURT.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 2008 ACT → State establishment after High Court consultation.
- NYAYADHIKARI → JMFC qualification.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- MOBILE FIRST INSTANCE → scheduled civil/criminal cases + conciliation.
- APPEAL → District Court / Sessions Court.

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP: not Panchayat, khap or Lok Adalat.
- 2008 ACT → State establishment after High Court consultation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- NYAYADHIKARI → JMFC qualification.
- MOBILE FIRST INSTANCE → scheduled civil/criminal cases + conciliation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MOBILE FIRST INSTANCE → scheduled civil/criminal cases + conciliation.

08

STAGE 08

FAMILY AND SPECIALIST-COURT DISTINCTIONS

FAMILY AND SPECIALIST-COURT DISTINCTIONS · FAMILY COURT · ADJUDICATION + CONCILIATION + PRIVACY + HIGH COURT APPEAL. · FAST TRACK · CAPACITY SCHEME. · SPECIAL COURT · PARENT-STATUTE JURISDICTION. · COMMERCIAL COURT

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- FAMILY COURT → adjudication + conciliation + privacy + High Court appeal.
- FAST TRACK → capacity scheme.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- SPECIAL COURT → parent-statute jurisdiction.
- COMMERCIAL COURT → statutory civil court and case management.

CHECK / LIMIT
- EVENING COURT → administrative sitting format.
- FAMILY COURT → adjudication + conciliation + privacy + High Court appeal.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- FAST TRACK → capacity scheme.
- SPECIAL COURT → parent-statute jurisdiction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMMERCIAL COURT → statutory civil court and case management.

09

STAGE 09

MEDIATION, ARBITRATION AND COURT FIREWALL

MEDIATION, ARBITRATION AND COURT FIREWALL · AFCONS INFRASTRUCTURE V. CHERIAN VARKEY CONSTRUCTION (2010) · STRUCTURED ADR REFERRAL. · PARTY-MADE SETTLEMENT. · PRIVATE ADJUDICATION AND STATUTORY AWARD CHALLENGE. · ORDINARY LOK ADALAT · COMPROMISE AWARD. · LIMITED POST-CONCILIATION ADJUDICATION.

Afcons Infrastructure v. Cherian Varkey Construction (2010) → structured ADR referral. → MEDIATION → party-made settlement. → ARBITRATION → private adjudication and statutory award challenge. → ORDINARY LOK ADALAT → compromise award. → PLA → limited post-conciliation adjudication.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Afcons Infrastructure v. Cherian Varkey Construction (2010) → structured ADR referral.
- MEDIATION → party-made settlement.
- ARBITRATION → private adjudication and statutory award challenge.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ORDINARY LOK ADALAT → compromise award.
- PLA → limited post-conciliation adjudication.
- CURRENT STATUS: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026

CHECK / LIMIT
- S.O. 4384(E) commenced only specified Mediation Act sections.
- S.O. 4781(E) established the Mediation Council of India at Delhi on
- 27 August 2026; this did not commence every remaining provision.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- ORDINARY LOK ADALAT → compromise award.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 27 August 2026; this did not commence every remaining provision.

10

STAGE 10

FAIRNESS, DATA AND DIGITAL ACCESS

FAIRNESS, DATA AND DIGITAL ACCESS · PATIL AUTOMATION V. RAKHEJA ENGINEERS (2022) · MANDATORY COMMERCIAL PRE-INSTITUTION MEDIATION ABSENT AN URGENT-RELIEF EXCEPTION. · CONSENT QUALITY · ADVICE + NO COERCION + UNDERSTOOD TERMS. · IDENTITY, PRIVACY, LANGUAGE, DISABILITY AND OFFLINE OPTION. · CURRENT DATA · DATE EVERY COUNT, CEILING AND NOTIFIED SERVICE.

Patil Automation v. Rakheja Engineers (2022)

mandatory commercial pre-institution mediation absent an urgent-relief exception. → CONSENT QUALITY → advice + no coercion + understood terms. → DIGITAL → identity, privacy, language, disability and offline option.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Patil Automation v. Rakheja Engineers (2022)
- mandatory commercial pre-institution mediation absent an urgent-relief exception.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- CONSENT QUALITY → advice + no coercion + understood terms.
- DIGITAL → identity, privacy, language, disability and offline option.

CHECK / LIMIT
- CURRENT DATA → date every count, ceiling and notified service.
- Patil Automation v. Rakheja Engineers (2022)

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- mandatory commercial pre-institution mediation absent an urgent-relief exception.
- CONSENT QUALITY → advice + no coercion + understood terms.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CURRENT DATA → date every count, ceiling and notified service.

11

STAGE 11

UPSC FORUM-SELECTION ANSWER SPINE

UPSC FORUM-SELECTION ANSWER SPINE · 1 LEGAL SOURCE. · 2 SUBJECT · 3 CONSENT OR MERITS POWER. · 4 AWARD · 5 ACCESS AND POWER-ASYMMETRY SAFEGUARDS. · AFFORDABLE JUSTICE MUST REMAIN COMPETENT AND VOLUNTARY WHERE REQUIRED. · ILLEGALITY REMAINS REVIEWABLE.

1 LEGAL SOURCE. → 2 SUBJECT / STAGE / COMPOUNDABILITY. → 3 CONSENT OR MERITS POWER. → 4 AWARD / APPEAL / REVIEW. → 5 ACCESS AND POWER-ASYMMETRY SAFEGUARDS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 1 LEGAL SOURCE.
- 2 SUBJECT / STAGE / COMPOUNDABILITY.
- 3 CONSENT OR MERITS POWER.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 4 AWARD / APPEAL / REVIEW.
- 5 ACCESS AND POWER-ASYMMETRY SAFEGUARDS.
- VERDICT: affordable justice must remain competent and voluntary where required.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Illegality remains reviewable.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: The Mediation Act remains only partly commenced
- 4781(E) established the Mediation Council of India at Delhi on 27 August 2026.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 4 AWARD / APPEAL / REVIEW.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: affordable justice must remain competent and voluntary where required.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: affordable justice must remain competent and voluntary where required.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · DISPUTE-SYSTEM DESIGN · CONSENT QUALITY AND POWER ASYMMETRY · DIGITAL JUSTICE · REFORM METRICS · TIME AND COST SAVED · REPRESENTATION AND INFORMED-CONSENT QUALITY · SETTLEMENT DURABILITY AND COMPLIANCE

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- Dispute-system design
- Consent quality and power asymmetry
- Digital justice
- Reform metrics

ADVANCED LIMIT
- time and cost saved;
- representation and informed-consent quality;
- settlement durability and compliance;
- geographic and social reach;

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- reasoned handling of failed settlement;
- staffing, infrastructure and legal-aid quality; and
- review of jurisdictional or natural-justice error.
- Apply only after the complete statutory and comparative Core.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels